



PRACTICE CARDS · UNDER 14

Lawn tennis stroke cards

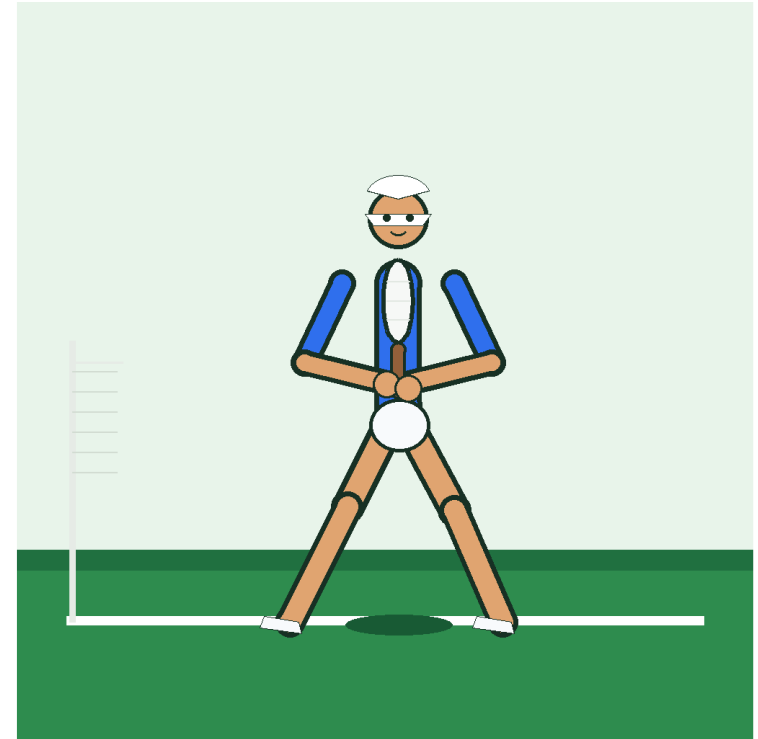
Hold up the picture. Say the four cues.
Then feed one easy ball and let them try.

1 Show

2 Say

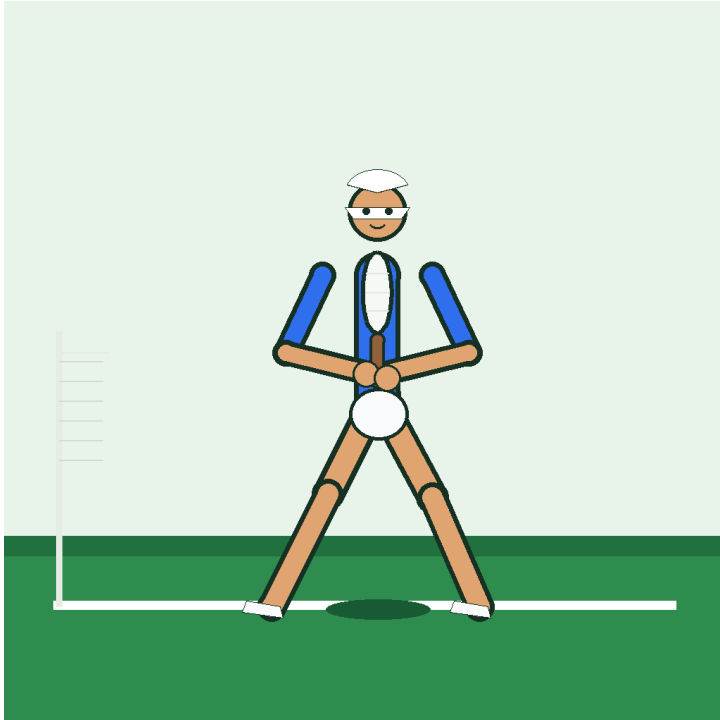
3 Feed

Pictures show a right-handed player.
Left-handers mirror every shape.



Start here · Ready position

Ready position



Wait like this between shots

How to use a card

- 1 Show the picture**
Point at the shape. Don't explain everything.
- 2 Say the four cues**
Use the same words every time.
- 3 Feed one easy ball**
Stand to the side. Keep the feed slow.
- 4 Watch one thing**
Only the quick fix. Praise the try.

1 Soft knees
Stay bouncy, not stiff

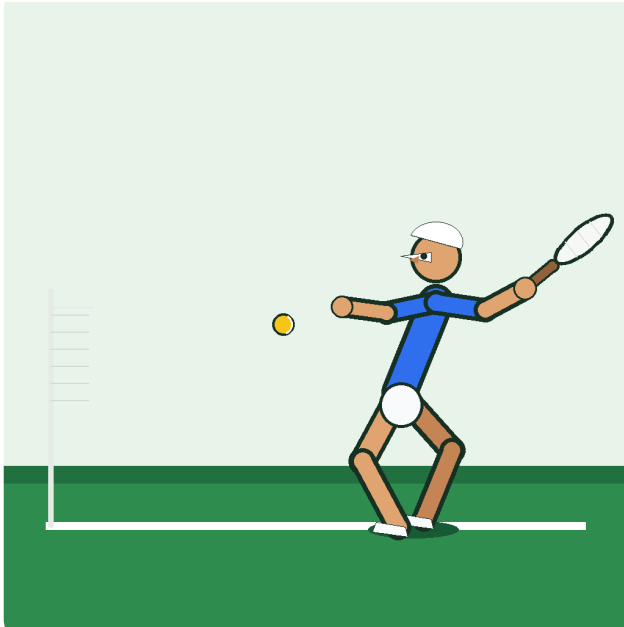
2 Racket in front
Both hands, near your tummy

3 Watch the ball
See it leave their racket

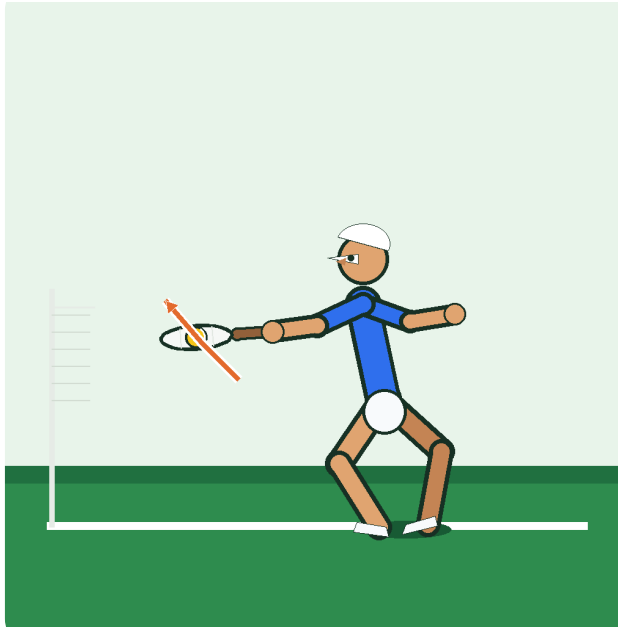
4 Split step
Little hop as they hit

QUICK FIX If the feet stick, the shot will be late. Stay bouncy.

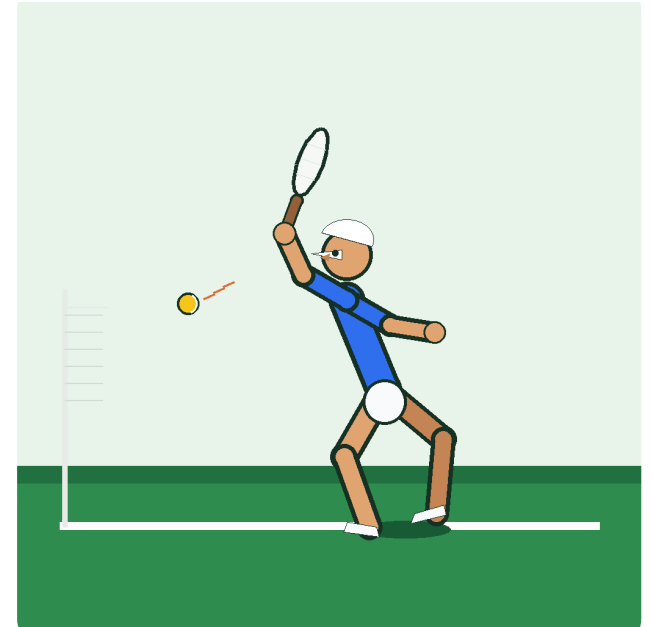
Forehand



1 Racket back



2 Hit in front



3 Finish high

1

Turn early

Before the bounce

2

Low to high

Drop it, then swing up

3

Hit in front

Meet it ahead of your body

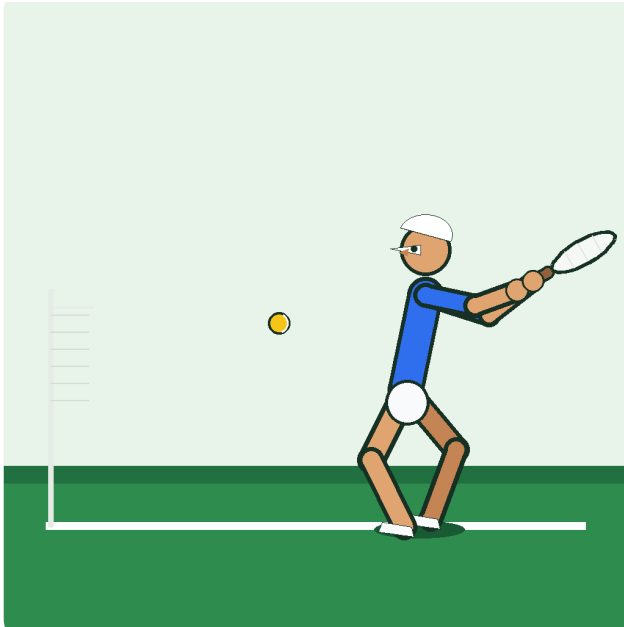
4

Finish high

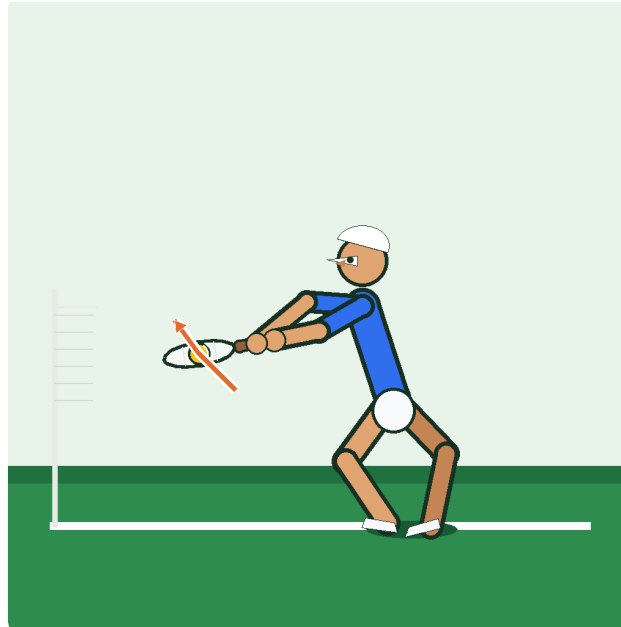
Racket over the shoulder

QUICK FIX Take the racket back before the ball bounces.

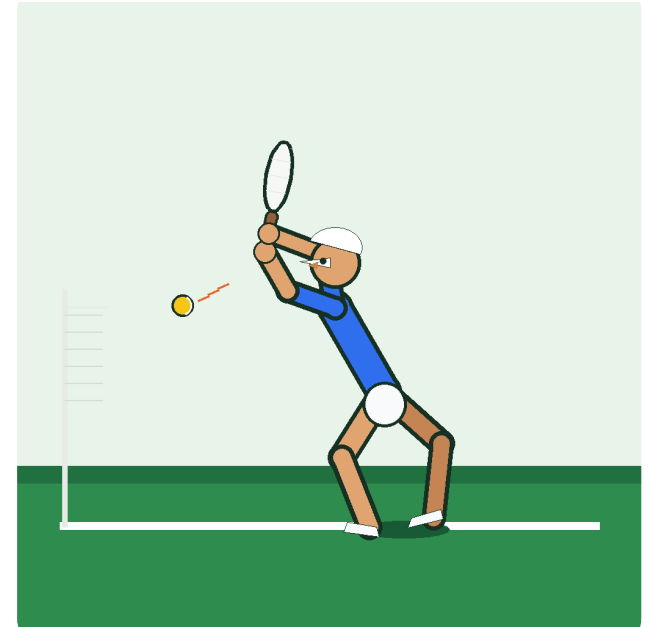
Backhand



1 Both hands back



2 Hit in front



3 Finish up

1

Two hands

Both hands stay on the racket

2

Turn early

Shoulders turn together

3

Hit in front

Meet the ball out in front

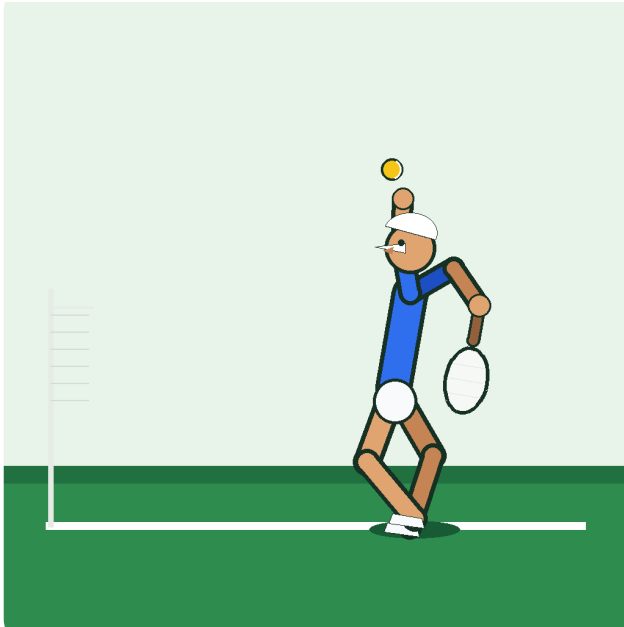
4

Finish up

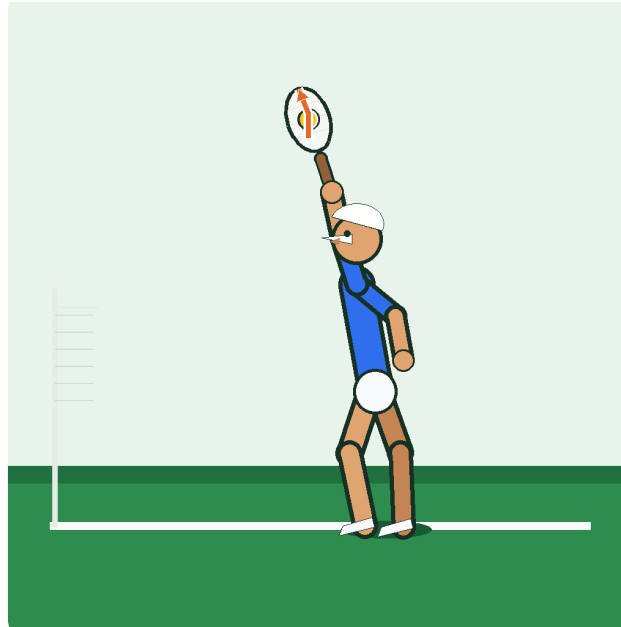
Hands finish high

QUICK FIX Keep both hands together from the start to the finish.

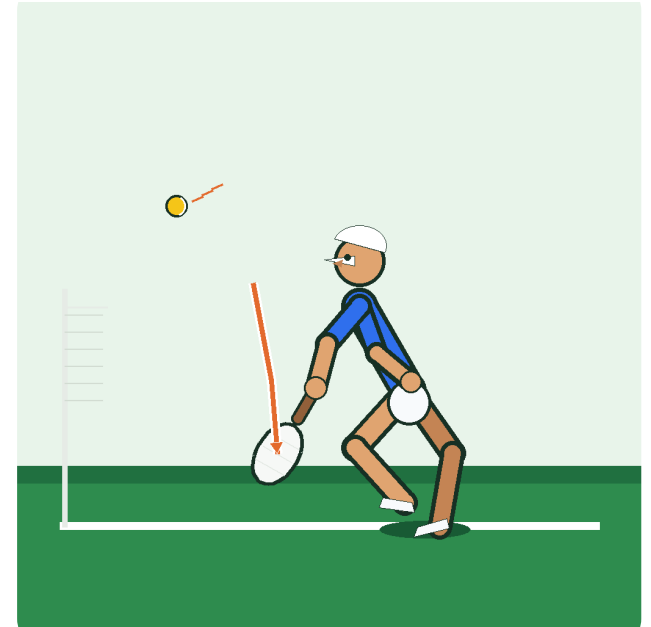
Serve



1 Toss and trophy



2 Hit at the top



3 Finish down

1 Toss in front

Up, and a little forward

2 Bend, then reach

Knees first, then get tall

3 Hit the top

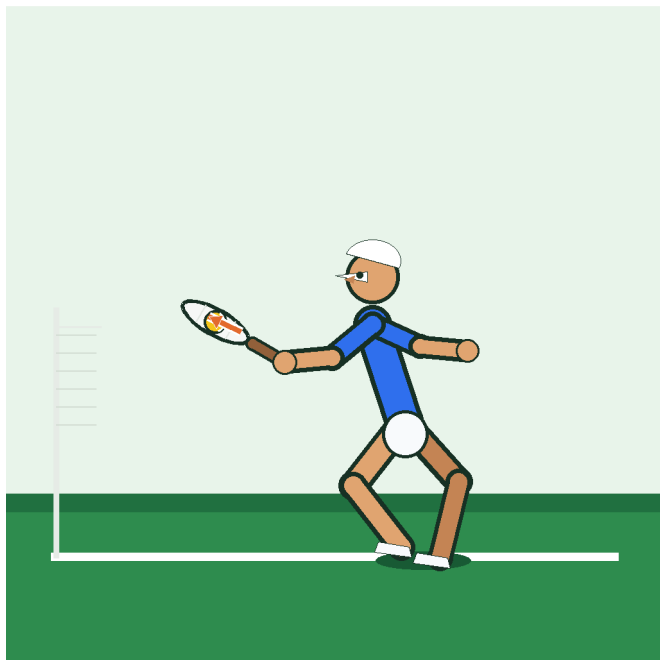
Contact as high as you can

4 Finish down

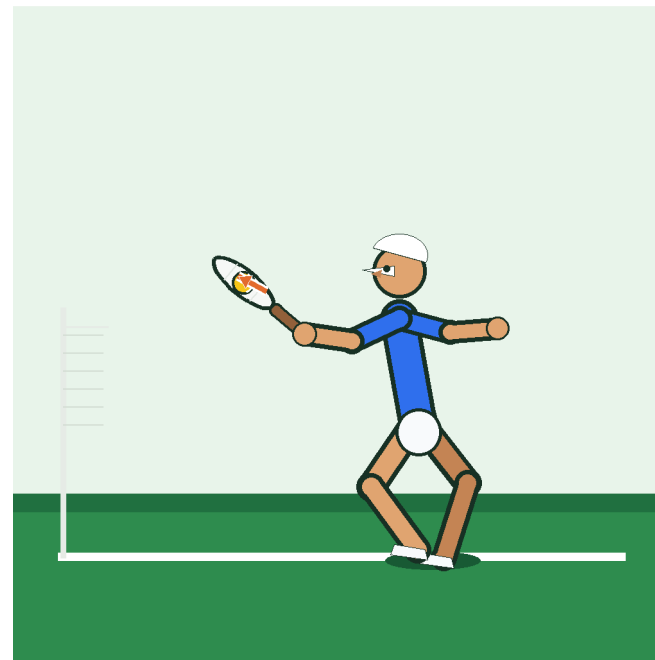
Racket by the opposite leg

QUICK FIX The racket ends down by your leg, not up like a forehand.

Volley



Forehand volley · short punch



Backhand volley · one hand

1

Step in

Move toward the ball

2

Short punch

No big swing

3

Head up

Racket head above the wrist

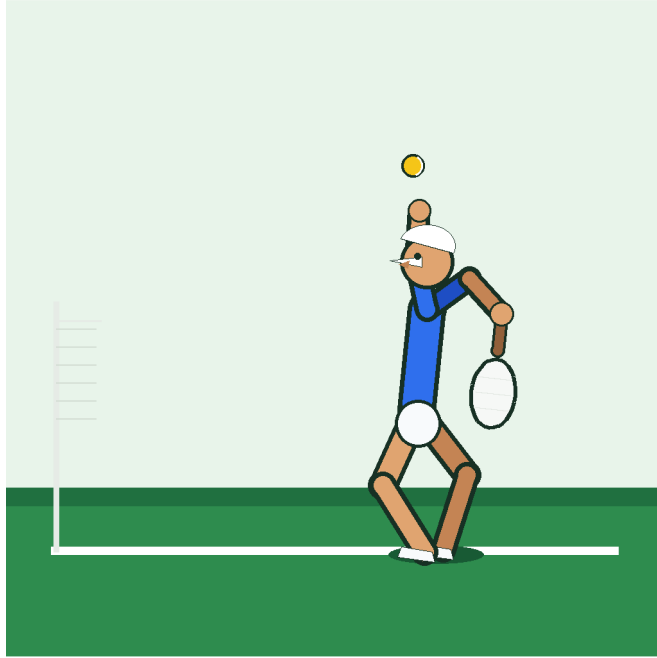
4

In front

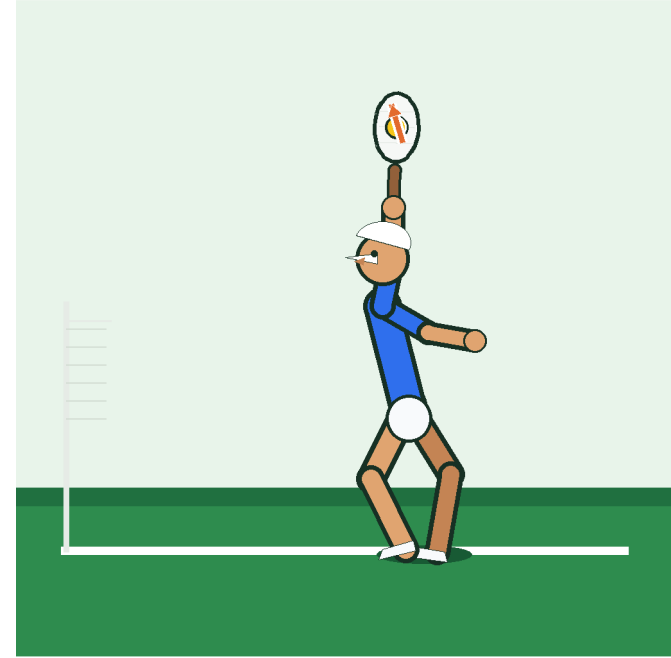
Meet the ball early

QUICK FIX A big swing is late. Punch, and keep the racket head up.

Overhead



1 Point at the ball



2 Hit it at the top

1

Turn sideways

Don't face the net square

2

Point first

Other hand shows the ball

3

Like a serve

Racket goes back, then up

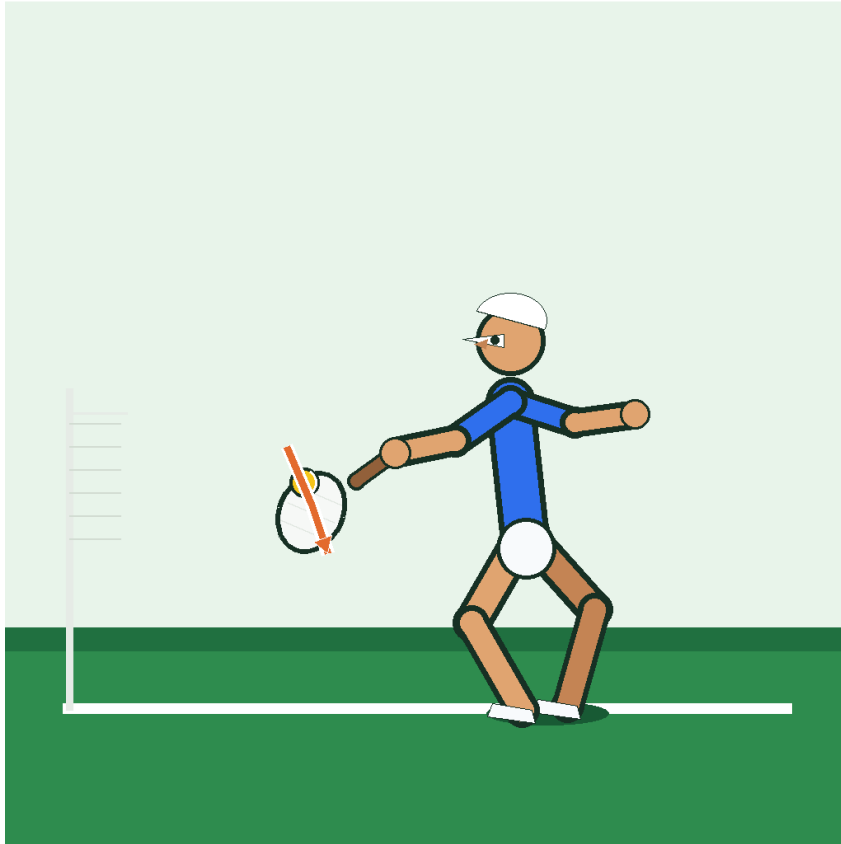
4

Watch it

Eyes stay on the ball

QUICK FIX Point at the ball before the swing. Then reach up to hit it.

Slice



Brush underneath the ball

1 Start high
Racket begins above the ball

2 Face open
Strings tilt back a little

3 High to low
Cut under, then through

4 Finish in front
Don't wrap over the shoulder

QUICK FIX Cut under the ball. A slice finishes in front, not over the shoulder.

Session plan

SAY THIS, THEN FEED

Ready	Bounce, racket in front, split step when they hit.
Forehand	Turn early, swing low to high, finish over the shoulder.
Backhand	Two hands stay together. Turn, and meet the ball in front.
Serve	Toss in front, hit at the top, racket finishes down.
Volley	Step in and punch. One hand on the backhand volley.
Overhead	Point at the ball, then hit it high, like a serve.
Slice	Open the face a little and brush under the ball.

COACH NOTES · not for the players to memorize

Forehand: a handshake grip is a fine start. Backhand on these cards is two-handed.
Serve, volley, overhead, and slice later use a hammer grip. First make the swing shape right.
One server at a time. Feed from the side. Stop the group if anyone feels pain.

Order on court

- 1 Ready and split step
- 2 Forehand feeds
- 3 Backhand feeds
- 4 Serve: toss, then hit
- 5 Volleys, close to the net
- 6 Overheads from a high feed
- 7 Slice, if there is time